

ment should emphasise the need to bridge regional healthcare disparities through inclusive and innovative strategies,” says Dr Ashutosh Raghuvanshi, MD and CEO of Fortis Healthcare.

McKinsey & Co suggests that, despite these challenges, the Indian healthcare market could reach \$400 billion by 2029. But more needs to be done. Ameera Shah, Promoter & MD of diagnostics chain Metropolis Healthcare, says health insurance could be widened to include outpatient diagnostics to make them affordable to all consumers. “By incorporating diagnostics into health insurance, we can standardise healthcare parameters for testing and create additional investment opportunities,” Shah says.

PHARMA POWERHOUSE

India’s pharmaceutical industry will transform from a generics giant into a \$550 billion innovation powerhouse by 2029. “We are on the brink of transformative change,” says Glenn Saldanha, Chairman and Managing Director of Glenmark Pharmaceuticals. The government’s focus on “moving up the value chain from volume to value” is at the heart of this transformation, he says.

While India currently dominates the world generics market, accounting for 20% of supply, challenges remain. Low R&D investment, a mere 1.2% of GDP, and heavy reliance on API imports are holding back the industry. “Boosting R&D and fostering domestic API production is key to unlocking the sector’s true potential,” says

Saldanha. Initiatives such as PRIP, or the Promotion of Research and Innovation in Pharma-MedTech Sector Scheme, and BRIC, or the Biotechnology Research and Innovation Council, aim to address these hurdles by cultivating an innovation ecosystem and propelling India into complex generics, speciality medicines, and even novel biological entities.

Mazumdar-Shaw of Biocon says a particularly lucrative frontier is complex generics and biosimilars. “Streamlining intellectual property regulations and incentivising investments can empower India to claim its rightful place in this high-growth segment,” she says.

Indian pharma companies such as Biocon, with their science-based targets initiative (SBTi) approval, are setting a high bar in this regard.

Mazumdar-Shaw identifies India’s unique strengths as the driving force behind this transformative journey. “Highly skilled local scientific talent, a thriving ecosystem of advanced technology and service capabilities, strong political commitment, and efficient governance,” she says.

The future of Indian healthcare hinges on next-generation therapeutics like cell and gene therapies, antibody-drug conjugates (ADCs), and DNA and RNA-based therapies. “The current imperative is to boost the overall speed and magnitude of innovation,” says Saldanha. So it is essential to invest in quality systems and talent continuously.”

DIAGNOSTICS DILEMMA

Non-communicable diseases (NCDs) are emerging as the biggest challenge for India’s healthcare system and account for over 70% of deaths, according to government data. Unhealthy lifestyles and limited preventative care call for a paradigm shift towards public health



“There is an urgent need to refine and expedite regulation of digitisation, telemedicine and online pharmacies”

KIRAN MAZUMDAR-SHAW
EXECUTIVE
CHAIRPERSON, BIOCON



“With increased per capita income translating to greater purchasing power, it is expected that more people will purchase health insurance”

ABHAY SOI
CHAIRMAN & MANAGING DIRECTOR,
MAX HEALTHCARE